

Boat Purchase Analysis — 2026 Nautique G23

Independent market verification · August 16, 2026 · All prices re-checked against current listings

RECOMMENDATION: PROCEED AT \$329,100 — a fair market price, and buying now beats waiting.

Condition: this makes sense if the current boat's lack of power genuinely limits use. The upgrade costs roughly \$40,000–\$45,000 per year of ownership — the deal is fair, but it is not a bargain that pays for itself.

1. THE DEAL

Sticker (MSRP) — loaded build: 630 hp supercharged engine, telescoping tower, full options	\$409,000
Negotiated price (includes triple-axle trailer)	\$329,100
Discount off sticker (\$79,900 off)	19.5%

- **The \$409,000 sticker is legitimate.** An Idaho dealer lists a 2026 G23 with the same telescoping tower but the smaller 450 hp engine at \$378,781. The 630 hp engine upgrade runs about \$30,000 — that lands right at \$409,000.
- **19.5% off is the going rate, not a special favor.** Dealers are publicly advertising about 17% off before anyone negotiates, and owner forums report 15–20% as normal in today's soft market — 25% in some regions.
- **Ignore the "25% effective discount" pitch.** It compares today's price to a guessed next-year sticker. No published evidence supports the claimed 7% increase (recent years ran 4–6%). The real discount is 19.5%.

2. ROOM TO ASK FOR A LITTLE MORE — AND WHY

The dealer is at the middle of the observed discount range, not the edge of it. A polite ask for another **\$8,000–\$12,000 off (target: \$317,000–\$321,000, about 21.5–22.5% off)** is backed by real leverage:

- **Documented precedent:** 25% discounts are being reported in some regions, and 17% is the advertised starting point at some dealers — so 19.5% is a mid-range outcome, not a ceiling.
- **The market is on the buyer's side:** 63% of dealers say their new-boat inventory is too high, wake boat retail sales are down about 10% this year, and listings are sitting 37% longer than a year ago. Dealers pay financing (floor-plan) interest every month a boat sits.
- **Timing:** it's late in the season and 2027 models are already being listed. A 2026 order or stock boat is worth more to the dealer sold now than carried into next spring.
- **A concrete comparison to name:** loaded G23 **Paragons** — the higher trim, with the same 630 hp engine — are advertised at \$365,000–\$389,000. Mentioning that you're cross-shopping one is honest and gives the dealer a reason to sharpen the pencil.
- **If they won't move on price, take it in kind:** freight/prep in writing (worth \$3,000–\$8,000 — currently unconfirmed), first service, cover/accessories. Worst case is a "no," which costs nothing.

3. WHAT THE 2020 BOAT IS WORTH

Year	Asking price	Detail	Source
2020	\$149,900	450 hp, 124 hrs — Mooresville, NC	OnlyInboards
2020	\$149,995	450 hp, 61 hrs — Irvine, CA (sale pending)	YachtWorld
2020	\$149,995	Dealer retail — Montgomery, TX	Boatzon

2020	\$124,967	Jacksons Gap, AL (low end)	Boat Trader
2020	\$155,000	Bakersfield, CA (high end)	Boat Trader
2021	\$158,000 SOLD	263 hrs — actual sale, May 2025	OnlyInboards
2019	\$119,500–\$134,900	Three listings, TX / UT	Boatzon

- Boats are selling 5–12% below asking, and a 2020 G23 owner reported an actual **\$112,000 dealer trade offer** on an owner forum.
- **Private sale: plan on about \$130,000** (realistic range \$125,000–\$138,000). Getting \$135,000–\$140,000 takes low hours and patience.
- **Dealer trade-in: about \$112,000** (range \$108,000–\$118,000).

4. NET COST TO SWITCH (IDAHO 6% SALES TAX)

	Trade in at \$112,000	Sell private at \$130,000
Purchase price	\$329,100	\$329,100
Amount that gets taxed	\$217,100 (price minus trade)	\$329,100 (full price)
Sales tax at 6%	+ \$13,026	+ \$19,746
Money back from the 2020	– \$112,000	– \$130,000
Net cost to switch	\$230,126	\$218,846

- **Plain English:** trading in saves \$6,720 of tax, but selling private brings in \$18,000 more cash — so **selling private comes out about \$11,300 ahead**.
- Simple rule: only trade in if a private sale would net less than the trade offer plus 6% — here, less than **\$118,720**.

5. BUY NOW VS. WAIT THREE YEARS

Buying now costs \$253,000 in 2029 terms: the \$218,846 net outlay above, plus \$34,500 that money would have earned invested at 5% for three years.

Waiting means: keep the 2020 (worth roughly \$100,000 by 2029), then buy new at 2029 prices, paying 6% tax on the full price.

If you wait until 2029...	2029 sticker	Price paid	Net cost then	Buying now saves
Best case: prices rise 5%/yr, 20% discounts persist	\$473,000	\$379,000	\$301,500	\$48,000
Middle case: prices rise 6%/yr, 15% discount	\$487,000	\$414,000	\$338,900	\$85,600
Worst case: prices rise 7%/yr, discounts shrink to 10%	\$501,000	\$451,000	\$379,000	\$125,700

- **Buying now is cheaper in every scenario tested** — by \$48,000 to \$126,000 — and skips three more years with the underpowered boat.
- Fair caveat: waiting does end with a brand-new 2029 boat instead of a three-year-old 2026. The comparison only approaches a tie if big discounts persist, price increases stay low, invested cash earns ~10%, and the 2020 holds value unusually well — all at the same time.

6. WHAT THE SWITCH REALLY COSTS OVER 4 YEARS

	Buy the 2026	Keep the 2020
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Value today / purchase basis	\$329,100	~\$130,000
Estimated value in 2030	\$185,000–\$205,000	\$95,000–\$105,000
Value lost over 4 years (depreciation)	\$125,000–\$145,000	\$25,000–\$35,000
Sales tax paid (gone either way)	\$19,746	—
Investment return given up on the cash (5%/yr)	~\$47,000	—
Extra cost of switching, 4 years	~\$165,000–\$180,000 — about \$40,000–\$45,000 per year	

That is the honest price of running a new 630 hp boat under full warranty instead of the 2020. The discount doesn't change it — the justification is use and enjoyment, not economics.

7. RESALE NOTES

- Nautique fully redesigned the G-Series in 2025, which is pushing down values of all older-body G23s — the 2020 included. Roughly 130 leftover new old-body boats are being cleared at discounts. **That argues for selling the 2020 sooner, not later.** The 2026 being purchased is the new body style, which helps its future resale.
- Worth one phone call before signing: loaded G23 Paragons with the same engine at \$365,000–\$389,000 asking — for \$30,000–\$50,000 more it may be the stronger long-term hold.

Sources: current listings on Boat Trader, OnlyInboards, YachtWorld, Boatzon and dealer sites; Idaho State Tax Commission (6% rate and trade-in credit rules); PlanetNautique owner forums (actual trade offers and discount reports); NMMA and dealer-sentiment surveys (market data). Listing prices are asking prices unless marked SOLD. Full source URLs are in the companion detailed report (boat-deal-verification.md).